

GURUDATH C. N.

Applications Engineering & Technical Sales Leader | CNC Machining Center | Die & Mold | 5-Axis | Aerospace
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Applications Engineering and Technical Sales Leader with 25+ years of hands-on expertise in Makino CNC machining centers, die & mold manufacturing, and precision machining process development. Demonstrated track record of leading application engineering teams, driving revenue growth through high-value technical demonstrations, and delivering customer-centric solutions across automotive, aerospace, medical, semiconductor, and die & mold industries. Expert-level proficiency in 3-axis and 5-axis vertical and horizontal machining center applications, CAD/CAM programming, and process optimization. Extensive cross-regional exposure spanning Asia and Europe markets.

CORE COMPETENCIES

3-Axis & 5-Axis Machining Centers	Die & Mold Application Engineering	High-Speed Machining (HSM)
CNC Process Development & Optimization	Technical Sales & Pre/Post Sales Support	CAD/CAM Programming (3-Axis & 5-Axis)
Makino VMC / HMC Applications	Electrode & EDM Machining	Customer Key Account Management
Machine Tool Demonstration & Validation	Dealer & Distribution Network Development	Cross-Functional Team Leadership & Training

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Spearheaded advanced Makino machining center applications across 10+ global markets including India, Singapore, Germany, Thailand, and Italy over a 25-year career with Makino.
- Designed and delivered high-accuracy 5-axis machining processes for aerospace components.
- Drove significant revenue growth by executing high-value Makino machine demonstrations and technical test cut evaluations, leading to successful closures of multi-unit sales in India and Southeast Asia.
- Successfully expanded Mill-Star cutting tool dealer and customer network across India, building a robust channel partner ecosystem and increasing product penetration in the die & mold segment.
- Developed and standardized precision machining processes for die & mold customers, reducing cycle times by up to 30% through optimized toolpath strategies and Makino-specific parameter tuning.
- Led Makino India's application team in executing customer trials and live demonstrations at major industry exhibitions including IMTEX, TAGMA converting exhibition leads to confirmed orders.
- Established application engineering training programs for internal teams across Asia, enhancing technical capability and after-sales support quality.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Section Manager – Application Engineering | Makino Asia Pte. Ltd., Singapore *Jan 2019 – Apr 2026*

- Led the regional application engineering team responsible for Makino VMC, HMC, and 5-axis machining center process development and customer engagement across Southeast Asia.
- Managed end-to-end technical sales support including pre-sales application studies, toolpath development, cut demonstrations, and post-sales process optimization.
- Developed and delivered comprehensive machining processes for die & mold, medical, aerospace structural, and semiconductor precision components using Makino F5, a500Z, DA300 and PS series platforms.
- Partnered with CAD/CAM vendors (Mastercam, hyperMILL, Solid CAM, NX) to validate and optimize 5-axis toolpaths for complex surface geometries on Makino machines.
- Conducted factory and on-site machine demonstrations for key accounts, providing technical evidence for machine capability and ROI justification.
- Trained customer operators and programmers on Makino control systems, including best practices for high-speed contouring, thermal compensation, and surface quality optimization.

Sales & Marketing Manager | HSM Consultants India *2017 – 2018*

- Established and developed dealer and channel partner network for Mill-Star cutting tools across India, targeting die & mold, automotive, and aerospace machining segments.
- Conducted technical product demonstrations, application studies, and on-site trials to validate cutting tool performance in CNC machining environments.
- Managed full sales cycle from lead generation and technical qualification to proposal, negotiation, and order closure.
- Provided technical support and application consultation to end customers for multi-axis machining challenges, process improvements, and productivity optimization.

Senior Manager – Application Engineering | Makino India Pvt. Ltd. *2016 – 2017*

- Led application engineering operations across Makino India's regional offices, overseeing a team of application engineers supporting machine sales and customer success.
- Managed the full application lifecycle: customer process review, machining trials, technical reports, and post-sale follow-up for VMC and HMC installations.
- Executed customer-facing machine demonstrations at Makino India's demo center in Bengaluru, achieving high conversion rates on technical validations.
- Represented Makino India at IMTEX and regional machine tool exhibitions; managed live machine demonstrations and customer engagement on the exhibition floor.
- Coordinated with Makino Japan and Makino Asia on application best practices, machine parameter updates, and customer-specific engineering solutions.

Progressive Leadership Roles – Application Engineering & Training | Makino (India, Germany, Thailand, Italy) 2000 – 2016

Over 16 years, held increasingly senior application engineering and training roles across Makino's global operations:

- **Makino India:** Application Engineer → Senior Application Engineer → Application Team Manager drove machining process development for die & mould, and precision components; supported machine commissioning and operator training.
- **Makino Germany (GmbH):** Application Engineering – European die & mould machining applications; worked closely with customers on Makino VMC platforms.
- **Makino Thailand:** Regional Application Engineering – Southeast Asian market support; high-speed machining process development for HDD component, die-mould and precision manufacturing.
- **Makino Italy:** Application Engineering – Die & mould machining applications; customer training and technical support across Italian industrial manufacturing customers.

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Makino Machine Platforms:

VMC Series | 5-Axis | HMC Series | Sinker EDM | Wire EDM

CAD/CAM Software:

NX CAM (Siemens) | FFCAM (Makino)

CNC Control Systems:

Makino Pro 5 (Fanuc-based) | Makino Pro 6 | SGI.5 High-Speed Contouring | | Geometric Intelligence (GI)

Industry Applications:

Die & Mold (Injection Mold, Die casting, Press Tool, Forging Die) | Aerospace (Structural Parts, Engine Components) | Automotive (Powertrain, Transmission Housing, Body Panels) | Medical (Implants, Surgical Instruments) | Semiconductor (Precision Fixtures, Lead Frames) | HDD Components

Machining Processes:

High-Speed Machining (HSM) | 5-Axis Simultaneous & 3+2 Machining | Hard Milling (up to 62 HRC) | Trochoidal Milling | Electrode Machining (Copper & Graphite) | Fine Surface Finishing | Carbide machining | Mirror surface machining | High Precision Machining

EDUCATION

Diploma in Tool & Die Making

Government Tool Room & Training Center (GTTC), Bengaluru, India

Specialized training in precision toolmaking, jig & fixture design, CNC machining fundamentals, and metrology.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Languages: English (Professional), Kannada (Native), Hindi (Fluent)
- Available for relocation and international travel as required by role.
- Extensive experience working in multicultural environments across Asia-Pacific and European markets.
- Active participant in IMTEX, EMO, AMB, and regional machine tool industry exhibitions.